

THE BEAUFORT SCALE

0: Calm	4: Moderate wind	8: Gale
1: Light air	5: Fresh breeze	9: Strong gale
2: Light breeze	6: Strong breeze	10: Storm
3: Gentle breeze	7: Near gale	11: Violent storm
		12: Hurricane

This is a breeze.

0: CALM
0-1MPH
(0-2KPH)

4: MODERATE BREEZE
13-18MPH
(20-29KPH)

8: GALE
39-46MPH
(62-74KPH)

12: HURRICANE
MORE THAN
73MPH (117KPH)

~Help!

Clouds form as water condenses, and rain and snow fall on land.

As air moves between hot and cold regions, it causes a change in air pressure, which creates wind. Winds move from areas of high pressure (where the air is cold) to areas of low pressure (where it is warmer). The strength of the wind is measured by the 13-point Beaufort Scale.

Winds

Wind circulation

As Earth rotates it causes the world's winds to circulate. This global corkscrew of circulating air moves warm air from the Equator to the Poles, and cold air in the opposite direction, thus maintaining a balance of temperatures around the world.

Water cycle

The air around us is always moist since it contains invisible water vapor. If the air is cooled, this vapor condenses into water and circulates between Earth and the atmosphere in a never-ending cycle—evaporating in the heat and returning as rain or snow in the cold.

Tornadoes

Tornadoes form below thunderclouds as whirling windstorms, and can bring devastating winds of up to 250mph (400kph).

Fog

Low-lying clouds of water droplets, known as fog, form when warm, moist air is cooled by the ground below. However, fog can also form on cold, calm nights, as heat absorbed by the ground during the day radiates back into the air, causing the air to heat up but then cool quickly to form fog.

Clouds

When water vapor in the air is lifted high up in the sky, it cools and condenses into a cloud. There are 10 basic types of clouds, which form at different heights in the atmosphere, and hardly a day goes by when there isn't a cloud in the sky.

